Igor B. Martins

Postdoctoral Researcher at Linköping University, also affiliated with Lund University

igor.martins@liu.se | ibmartins.com Malmö, Sweden

Academic Experience

2020– **Postdoctoral Researcher**

Linköping University Sweden 2026–
Lund University Sweden 2023–2026
University of Cambridge United Kingdom 2022–2023
Lund University Sweden 2020–2022

2017–2018 **Visiting Researcher**

Stellenbosch University South Africa

Education

2016–2020 **Ph.D., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2014–2016 **M.Sc., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2008–2011 **B.Sc., Economics**

Fundação Getulio Vargas Brazil

Published works

- **Martins, I.** (forthcoming). Living standards in Ghana, 1955–2005, in G. Austin, A. Britwum, L. Doumbia, A. Eckert, & N.Y. Sapong (eds), *Labour and Work in Ghana Since Independence*, London: Bloomsbury Academic.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (forthcoming). Från arbetskraft till kapital: Slaveriets ekonomiska logik i globalt perspektiv, *Statsvetenskaplig tidskrift*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and coercion: Slavery after the 1807 import ban in the Cape Colony, *European Review of Economic History*, heag012.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2026). Theoretical foundations of the economics of slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Journal of Global History*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp.22–40.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Is the business of conquest the conquest of business?, *The Case Centre*, 225-0045-1.
- Cilliers, J., Mariotti, M., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Fertility responses to short-term economic stress: Price volatility and wealth shocks in a pre-transitional settler colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101620.

- Axelsson, T., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Resilience to shrinking as a catch-up strategy: A comparison of Brazil and Indonesia, 1964–2019, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, vol. 59, no. 3, pp.491–516.
- Smythe, A., **Martins, I.**, & Andersson, M. (2024). Inequality, poverty, and resilience to economic shrinking, *International Journal of Development Issues*, vol. 23, no. 1, pp.40–81.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). An age of disentangled research?, *Issues in Science and Technology*, vol. 40, no. 1, pp.38–43.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2023). Legacies of loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101506.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). *Shifting Patterns in International Research Cooperation*, Stockholm: STINT.
- **Martins, I.** (2020). Collateral effect: Slavery and wealth in the Cape Colony, PhD thesis, Department of Economic History, Lund University.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2019). What caused poverty reduction in Brazil during the 2000s: Sectoral growth or public expenditures, *OASIS. Observatorio de Análisis de los Sistemas Internacionales*, no. 31, pp.185–213.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2018). Poverty and democracy: The Brazilian experience, in D. Rauhut & N. Hatti (eds), *Poverty, Politics and the Poverty of Politics*, New Delhi: B.R. Publishing Corporation, pp.193–210.

Works under review

- **Martins, I.** (2026). The case for artisanal doctoral supervision, *Studies in Higher Education*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Retrieval-restricted reasoning: Supporting scholarly synthesis with language models, *Historical Methods: A Journal of Quantitative and Interdisciplinary History*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.**, Grab, S., & Green, E. (2026). Weather as a vector of inequality, *Nature Communications*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony, *Cliometrica*. Submitted.
- Makuei, J., & **Martins, I.** (2026). Democracy and rural inequality in Kenya, 1997–2010, *African Affairs*. Submitted.

Work in progress

- **Martins, I.** Income inequality in late colonial Angola, 1940–1970.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Wealth and adult mortality in a pre-industrial settler society: Evidence from Cape probate inventories.
- **Martins, I.**, Schoots, J., & Green, E. Held by the elite: Monopoly rights and family fortunes at the Cape of Good Hope, 1680–1794.
- Smythe, A., & **Martins, I.** Catch-up and resilience to shrinking, 1890–2019.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Forebearers: The forgotten women of the Cape Colony.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. What are institutions made of? A social contract approach.

- **Martins, I.**, Aboagye, P., & Austin, G. The Ghanaian divergence: Prices, incomes and living standards after independence.

External funding

2027–2029 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Flying Blind: Tsetse Ecology, Colonial Response and Long-Run Health in Southeast Africa (P26-0357) Project researcher. Engaged at 30% for three years.
SEK 1,500,000 (≈ EUR 138,500 / USD 163,000)

2024–2027 **Vetenskapsrådet**
Causes and Consequences of Long-Term Inequality: Africa's Levels and Trends (2023-00809_VR) Project researcher. Engaged at 20% for two years.
SEK 6,737,000 (≈ EUR 623,623 / USD 735,688)

2022–2026 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Resilience to Economic Shrinking: The Role of Autonomous Financial Systems (P21-0044) Project researcher. Engaged at approx. 30% for two years.
SEK 1,725,000 (≈ EUR 150,000 / USD 164,000)

2022–2025 **Arts and Humanities Research Council (UK)**
Where have all the Workers Gone? Labour and Work in Ghana, 1951–2010 (AH/W010852/1) Postdoctoral Research Associate. Engaged at 100% for one year.
SEK 3,332,000 (≈ EUR 308,438 / GBP 268,859)

2021–2026 **Riksbankens Jubileumsfond**
The establishment, growth and legacy of a settler colony: Quantitative panel studies of the political economy of the Cape Colony (M20-0041) Project researcher. Engaged at 40% for four years (2021–2024) and 20% for two years (2025–2026).
SEK 29,000,000 (≈ EUR 2,520,000 / USD 2,760,000)

2017–2018 **Erasmus Mundus Action 2 Programme (INSPIRE)**
Scholarship Stellenbosch University, South Africa
Supported research training on the economic history of the Cape Colony.
SEK 157,000

Teaching experience

2025– **Development in a Historical Perspective - Economic, Social and Political Transformation**
Lund University Course convener

2023–2026 **Growth, Stagnation, and Inequality in Africa**
Lund University Course convener

2019– **Colonialism and Economic Change in Africa, Asia and Latin America**
Lund University Lecturer

2020–2026 **The Art of Writing and Reporting**
Lund University Course convener

2019–2026 **Field Work/Internship and Research Overview**
Lund University Course convener

Pedagogical qualifications

2025 **Course design in higher education**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2024 **Doctoral supervision**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2022 **Teaching and learning in higher education II**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2021 **Teaching and learning in higher education I**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2020 **How to teach with cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

2019 **How to write cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

Supervision

2023–2026 **Doctoral**
Benjamin Chatterton, PhD in Economic History Lund University
Co-supervisor
Expected completion November 2026

2021– **Master's**
14 theses in Economic History Lund University

2019– **Bachelor's**
7 theses in Economic History Lund University

Awards

2020 **Teacher of the Year**
Lund University School of Economics and Management

Selected Media Outreach

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Assessing students' academic writing when AI can produce a first draft, *Times Higher Education*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Students learn best when they're not handed a map: 4 steps to structure discomfort in your case classroom, *Inspiring Minds*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Devo, não nego, pago com o meu escravo - Como pessoas escravizadas viravam garantia de crédito, *The Conversation Brasil*.

Full list at ibmartins.com/research.

Editorial and Review Experience

Editor, *Frontiers in African Economic History*, 2026–.

Peer reviewer for *Asia-Pacific Economic History Review*, *International Journal of Development Issues*, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, *Studies in Higher Education*, and *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*.

Service

2026– **International Economic History Association**
Secretariat
Supports the Secretary General with the administration of the association and the preparation of the World Economic History Congress, and keeps the record of Executive Committee meetings.

2025–2026 **United Nations Development Programme**
Consultant
Commissioned by the UNDP's Strategy, Policy and Capacities for Economic Management (SPACE) Unit of South Sudan as a consultant to the country's first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) report.

2023– **Swedish Economic History Association**
Auditor
The SEHA promotes the spread of knowledge about economic and social history, as well as historical and geographical research. The association organises lectures and conferences.

2023–2025 **World Economic History Congress 2025**
Lund, Sweden
Conference Manager
Responsible for the academic and cultural programme for more than 1,100 participants.

2021–2023 **Swedish Economic History Association**
Treasurer

2017– **Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past**
Stellenbosch University
Visiting Researcher
The Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past is dedicated to the quantitative study of African economic and social history.

Recent conferences, workshops and seminars

03/2027 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker** (scheduled)
What is the difference between colonialism and globalisation?

10/2026 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
University of Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**
Weather as a vector of inequality

02/2026 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker**
How did colonial institutions shape African democracy and development?

07/2025 **World Economic History Congress**
Lund, Sweden **Organiser & Panellist**
The geography of development in Portuguese Africa: Lessons from Angola

12/2024 **African Studies Association**
Chicago, USA **Panellist**
Market integration and the development of capitalism in Ghana, 1987–2005

12/2023 **Utbildningsdepartementet**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Seminarium om förändrade mönster för internationella forskningssamarbeten**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Lund, Sweden **Organizer & Panellist**
Catch-up and resilience to shrinking, 1890–2019

03/2023 **African Economic History Seminar**
Cambridge, United Kingdom **Panellist**
Raising capital to raise crops: Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony

Administrative references

Prof. Mats Olsson
Lund University, Sweden
mats.olsson@ekh.lu.se

Prof. Leigh Gardner
London School of Economics, UK
l.a.gardner@lse.ac.uk

Academic references

Prof. Erik Green
Lund University, Sweden
erik.green@ekh.lu.se

Prof. Gareth Austin
University of Cambridge, UK
gma31@cam.ac.uk

Prof. Anne McCants
MIT, USA
amccants@mit.edu

Prof. Jeanne Cilliers
Linköping University, Sweden
jeanne.cilliers@liu.se

Teaching references

Dr. Tobias Axelsson
Lund University, Sweden
tobias.axelsson@ekh.lu.se

Assoc. Prof. Tobias Karlsson
Lund University, Sweden
tobias.karlsson@ekh.lu.se